COMM 3180

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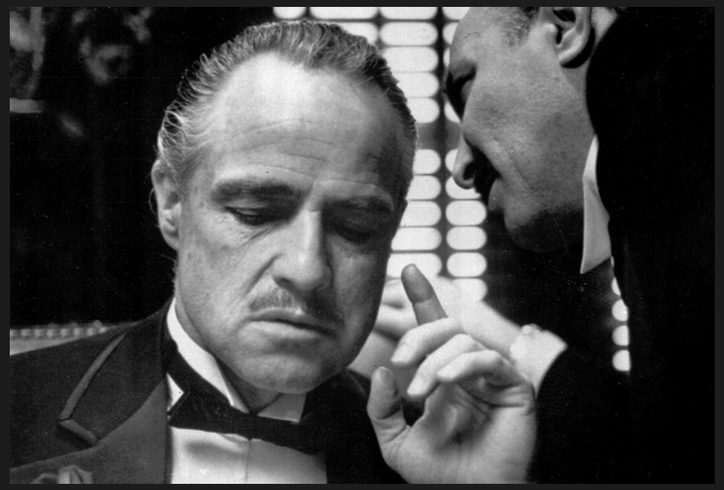
DEMOGRAPHICS OF E.G.O.T. WINNERS

WHAT ARE THE AWARDS?



EMMY

- The Emmy Award has recognized outstanding achievement in American primetime television since 1949, presented by the Television Academy.

- Voted on by the Television Academy's roughly 25,000 peer members — working television professionals who vote within their own craft categories (actors vote on acting, directors on directing, and so on)

- Covers 120+ competitive categories across three separate ceremonies — the Primetime Emmy Awards, Creative Arts Emmy Awards, and Engineering Emmy Awards .

- Recognizes content airing on broadcast, cable, and streaming platforms; expansion into streaming from roughly 2013 onward (Netflix, Hulu, etc..) broadened the field of eligible productions, introduced new creative teams into Emmy competition.

GRAMMY

- The Grammy Award has recognized outstanding achievement across the recorded music industry since 1959, presented by the Recording Academy (formerly the National Academy of Recording Arts and Sciences, NARAS), founded in 1957

- Voted on by approximately 13,000 Recording Academy members; spans artists, producers, engineers, songwriters, and other music professionals across all genres

- Covers ~95 competitive categories organized across genre fields (pop, rock, R&B, rap, country, jazz, classical, Latin, gospel, and more) plus craft categories (production, engineering, packaging, music video); the second broadest category structure after the Emmys

- Category structure is organized primarily by genre rather than by role — meaning the same person can be recognized in multiple genre fields, and genre expansion directly creates new demographic winner pools (e.g., Latin Grammy categories, added in 2000 as a separate ceremony)

OSCARS

- The Academy Award — universally known as the Oscar — has recognized outstanding achievement in the American film industry since 1929, making it the oldest of the four EGOT awards; presented by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences (AMPAS), founded in 1927

- Voted on by AMPAS members organized into 17 craft branches (Actors, Directors, Writers, Producers, Composers, etc.); nominations in each category are determined by the relevant branch, while the full membership votes on Best Picture — a structure that historically made the voting body self-perpetuating, since membership required prior nomination or invitation

- Covers ~24 competitive categories annually — the second fewest after the Tonys — spanning acting, directing, writing, producing, cinematography, editing, score, song, and technical crafts.

TONY

- The Tony Award (formally the Antoinette Perry Award for Excellence in Broadway Theatre) has recognized outstanding achievement in live Broadway theater since 1947, named after director and co-founder of the American Theatre Wing, Antoinette Perry

- Covers ~26 competitive categories annually across performance (play and musical), direction, choreography, scenic/lighting/costume design, original score, and book — the fewest categories of any EGOT award

- Exclusively recognizes productions on Broadway — defined as performances in one of approximately 41 theaters in Manhattan with 500+ seats

RESEARCH QUESTIONS

- What are the demographic profiles (gender, race/ethnicity, age, primary discipline) of winners in each individual award (Emmy, Grammy, Oscar, and Tony) separately?
- How do those demographic patterns differ across the four awards, and what structural or industry-level factors might explain those differences?
- Which of the four awards has shown the most improvement in demographic diversity since 1990, and which has changed the least ?
- How long after each award's founding did it take for women and people of color to first win in major categories?
- What award do EGOT winners tend to win last (the "hardest to get"), and does that pattern differ by discipline or demographic group?
- How does the intersection of gender and race/ethnicity shape patterns of winning across the four awards; do women of color face a compounded disadvantage?

RESEARCH METHODS

- OUR DATA
- DATA COLLECTION & SORTING
- PER-AWARD DEMOGRAPHIC ANALYSIS
- CROSS-AWARD ANALYSIS
- EGOT ANALYSIS

OUR DATA

EXISTING DATA SETS AND POSSIBLE SOURCES OF WEB-SCRAPED DATA

EMMY AWARD WINNERS, 1949-2017

- Source: kaggle
- Broken down by award category and year
- Missing data from 2018-
- **Missing demographic information for winners and nominees**

GRAMMY AWARD WINNERS, 1965-2024

- Source: kaggle
- Broken down by award category and year
- Missing data from 1959-1964 and 2025-
- **Missing demographic information for winners and nominees**

ACADEMY AWARD WINNERS, 1927-2014

- Source: data.world
- Broken down by award category, race/ethnicity, and year
- Missing data from 2015-

TONY AWARD WINNERS, 1947-2025

- Source: r/Broadway (data will be vetted thoroughly)
- Broken down by award category and year
- **Missing demographic information for winners and nominees**

DATA COLLECTION AND SORTING

- Download and load the four primary datasets from the listed sources; supplement Emmy and Grammy Kaggle files with official database records for 2020–2026

- Hand-compile the EGOT master spreadsheet (n ≈ 28) from Wikipedia, Britannica, and Billboard, with columns for: name, year_E, year_G, year_O, year_T, year_egot_completed, age_at_completion, nationality, primary_discipline, gender, race_ethnicity

- Code demographic variables for each winner: gender (from public self-identification), race/ethnicity (researcher-coded from Wikipedia and IMDb biographies into six broad categories), and nationality (country of birth / primary citizenship at time of first win); document all coding decisions in a codebook.

- Possible use of Natural Language Processing and AI to streamline demographic identification process

PER-AWARD ANALYSIS

- For each of the four awards separately, calculate frequency distributions of winners by gender, race/ethnicity, nationality, and primary discipline; express as percentages of total winners in each category for comparability across awards with different total winner counts

- Focusing on performing categories for the Emmys, Oscars, and Tonys; focusing on the “Big 4” for the Grammys (Album of the Year, Song of the Year, Record of the Year, and Best New Artist)

- Group winners by decade (1930s–2020s) and calculate the proportion of women and people of color per decade for each award; visualize as line or area charts — the primary visualization for tracking whether and when each award became more diverse over time

- More demographic analysis!

CROSS-AWARD COMPARISON

- Plot side-by-side grouped bar charts displaying gender and racial composition of winners for all four awards simultaneously; allows direct visual comparison of which award looks most and least diverse on each demographic dimension.

- Run chi-square tests of independence to assess whether differences in demographic composition across awards are statistically significant

- For awards with documented institutional reform — Oscar (2016 AMPAS diversity initiative), Grammy (2020 Recording Academy task force) — split the dataset at the reform year and run chi-square comparisons of pre- vs. post-reform demographic distributions within that award.

- Examine category count as an explanatory variable: test whether the Grammy's broader category architecture (95+) produces more demographic variety than the Oscar and Tony's narrower structures (~24–26 categories), and whether diversity gains at the Grammys are concentrated in newly added genre categories vs. long-standing ones.

EGOT COMBINED ANALYSIS

- There are approximately 28 EGOT winners total — 22 who won all four awards competitively, and 6 who completed the set with at least one honorary or special award; we treat these two groups separately throughout
- Note that every non-American EGOT winner to date is British or Western European — no winner has come from Latin America, Asia, Africa, or the Global South despite those regions producing internationally recognized artists across all four relevant industries.
- Compare the demographic makeup of EGOT winners against the broader winner pools of each individual award.
- Record the order in which each winner received their four awards (e.g., Oscar first, then Tony, then Grammy, then Emmy) and visualize all pathways.
- Identify the most common entry point — which award do most EGOT winners collect first — and whether that first award tends to predict how quickly the remaining three follow.